Blake Almanza

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Education

B.S. in Software Development, Emphasis in Mobile App Development GPA: 4.0
Grand Canyon University – Honors College *Apr. 2027*

Experience

Freelance Designer & Developer Apr. 2025 – Present
Washington State Barrel Racing Info | Next.js, Supabase, Python

- Designed and built an event platform for **200+ users** with calendar views, filters, and paid memberships.
- Built Python scrapers for 3 event sources with fuzzy de-duplication, cutting manual event entry by **80%**.
- Migrated the site from Vite to Next.js 16, adding automated registration alerts and Google Calendar sync.

Annie's House + Farm Sitting | Astro, React, Cloudflare Workers

- Led end-to-end design in code, from brand positioning to layout, typography, and a token-based style system.
- Building an accessible date-range booking flow with React Aria, backed by live Google Calendar availability.

Projects

PriceRight | *React Native (Expo), TypeScript, C#/.NET, Azure* Sep. 2025 – Present

- Led a full UI redesign of a cross-platform pricing app, rebuilding 25+ screens with native iOS navigation.
- Designed the brand identity: logo, Liquid Glass app icon in Icon Composer, and launch animation.
- Eliminated loading spinners on repeat visits by caching API data and preloading hidden tabs.
- Implemented Microsoft Entra OAuth with secure token storage, silent renewal, and session restore.
- Wrote regression test suites for navigation, sessions, caching, and startup, run in GitHub Actions CI.

Better Halo | *React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Web Extension APIs* Oct. 2025 – Present

- Developed and shipped a Chrome Web Store extension used by **1,100+ students** to improve GCU's Halo LMS.
- Built a theming system with CSS variables, custom themes, synced preferences, and scheduled dark mode.
- Reverse-engineered and documented Halo's private GraphQL API to add assignment tracking and course shortcuts.

Mosaic | *C++, LVGL, ESP32-P4, TypeScript* Oct. 2026 – Present

- Own the firmware and on-device LVGL interface for a connected desk display with a 5" touchscreen.
- Built a design token pipeline generating CSS, lint rules, and a firmware C header from one JSON source.
- Implemented phone-based Wi-Fi setup via on-screen QR code and captive portal, verified on hardware.

Golf Caddie | *React, TypeScript, AWS, Google Maps API, Figma* Jun. 2025 – Oct. 2025

- Built a mobile-first PWA for GPS yardages, course visualization, shot tracking, and club recommendations.
- Designed the mobile UI and branding in Figma, then built it in React.
- Used Google Maps APIs to render hole layouts and calculate GPS distances to targets and greens.

Technical Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, C#, C++, Python, Java
Frontend: React, React Native, Expo, Next.js, Astro, Tailwind CSS, CSS Modules, Bootstrap, React Aria, LVGL
Design: Figma, Apple Icon Composer, design systems, design tokens, accessibility, responsive & mobile UI
Backend & Cloud: Node.js, .NET, GraphQL, REST, Azure, AWS, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Cloudflare
Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (Nov. 2024)